

AI Bid Returns

S&P 500 closes at fresh record on stronger-than-expected April payrolls. Nasdaq +1.71%. AMD +11.44% extends, QCOM +8.17% on Daiwa upgrade and data center pivot.

THE SESSION

The tape closed the week back at fresh records. The S&P 500 finished at 7,397.43 (+0.82%), the Nasdaq added 1.71% to 26,247.08, and the Dow held flat at 49,609.15. The Russell 2000 added 0.76% to 2,861.21. VIX edged up to 17.19 even as the index complex pushed higher, the muted volatility footprint suggesting positioning rather than panic on the backdrop of a continuing Hormuz exchange.

The session resolved Thursday's open question cleanly. April payrolls printed 115,000 against the 62,000 consensus and unemployment held at 4.3%, with average hourly earnings at +0.2% month-over-month coming in slightly below the +0.3% estimate. The combination — firmer hiring without an accompanying wage acceleration — is the configuration the equity tape rewards: economic resilience without the pressure that would force a hawkish Fed pivot. Markets shrugged off the Michigan preliminary sentiment print at 48.2 (versus 49.5 expected, a fresh record low) because the inflation expectation series within the survey actually softened — one-year to 4.5% from 4.7%, five-year to 3.4% from 3.5%.

Beneath the index print, the AI semiconductor complex carried the weight. AMD added 11.44% to \$455.19 extending Wednesday's post-earnings move; QCOM advanced 8.17% to \$219.09 on a Daiwa upgrade to Outperform with the price target raised to \$225 from \$140; FTNT continued its post-print rally with another 5.65% gain to \$114.07. The cybersecurity, semicap, and data-center silicon sleeves all repriced higher in concert. Healthcare remained the consistent laggard — ABT (–3.09%) and SYK (–2.98%) anchored the dividend book's decliners as the sector continued to trade through its own multi-month drawdown.

IOWN Tactical: Records on a strong jobs print with vol contained and the AI complex leading is the textbook risk-on resolution. The committee's framework remains unchanged — with the S&P 500 well above 200DMA and now at fresh highs, the BUY tranches sit dormant. The tactical posture is patience.

IOWN HOLDINGS: NOTABLE MOVERS

WINNERS

AMD +11.44%

GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Closed at \$455.19 extending the post-earnings move. Rackspace announced a memorandum of understanding to develop an enterprise AI cloud on AMD silicon for regulated and sovereign workloads, adding to the OpenAI and Meta deployment commitments already in the pipeline. The 'changing of the guard in AI' thesis — Intel, AMD, and Micron taking share of the AI infrastructure narrative — is the cleanest framing of this week's tape.

QCOM +8.17%

DIVIDEND STRATEGY

Closed at \$219.09 after Daiwa upgraded to Outperform and raised the price target to \$225 from \$140, citing the data center AI pivot. The hyperscaler custom silicon engagement is on track for initial shipments later this calendar year per CEO Cristiano Amon, sitting alongside the \$20 billion buyback authorization and the closed Alphawave acquisition.

FTNT +5.65%

GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Closed at \$114.07 extending Thursday's post-print rally on the Q1 beat-and-raise. Cybersecurity demand into elevated geopolitical-cyber risk and the FY2026 revenue guide lift to roughly 15% growth keep the tape constructive on the name.

COIN +4.25%

GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Closed at \$201.16 recovering from Thursday's post-print decline. Despite the Q1 GAAP loss, the record 8.6% trading market share and 169% Y/Y derivatives volume growth gave the tape a constructive read once the initial reaction worked through.

AEM +2.90%

GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Closed at \$193.21 with gold at \$4,727.10 (+0.34%). The gold-equity complex continues to track the broader monetary-debasement thesis and the geopolitical bid that has held through the Hormuz exchanges.

LRCX +2.63%

DIVIDEND STRATEGY

Closed at \$294.05 as the semicap names participated in the broader AI infrastructure rally. The category continues to benefit from analyst confidence in the WFE cycle and AI-related capital intensity.

DECLINERS

SUPV –7.11%

GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Closed at \$7.97 continuing the digestion of Tuesday's Q1 print. The quarter included roughly AR\$36.6 billion in extraordinary severance and early-retirement charges from a headcount rightsizing plan; ex-items efficiency would have been 55.8% versus the reported 68.9%. Argentine bank correction continues against the broader sector pullback.

ABT -3.09%

DIVIDEND STRATEGY

Closed at \$84.32 trading near the 52-week lows. The healthcare complex remained the day's clearest laggard against the AI-led tape. The Exact Sciences integration is now in process and the 55-year dividend growth streak provides a structural floor that the price action has yet to acknowledge.

SYK -2.98%

DIVIDEND STRATEGY

Closed at \$285.47 with the medtech sleeve continuing to digest the March cyberattack disruption that contributed to the Q1 miss. Management reaffirmed full-year guidance; the share-price reaction reflects sentiment unwind more than fundamental impairment.

HUT -2.69%

GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Closed at \$98.46 as the crypto sleeve continued to digest the prior-week run. Bitcoin holding near \$80,236 (+0.28%) gave the asset class direction without the operational variance that the miner names are pricing.

SSNC -1.91%

DIVIDEND STRATEGY

Closed at \$68.76 with no name-specific catalyst — consistent with broader rotation out of defensive software-services into the higher-beta AI-infrastructure complex that led the day.

TEL -1.84%

DIVIDEND STRATEGY

Closed at \$206.20 in a session where the broader industrial-electronics complex traded heavier despite the index print. The connector category sat outside the AI-bid that defined the day.

HOLDINGS NEWS

QCOM — Daiwa upgrade. Daiwa moved Qualcomm to Outperform from Neutral and raised the price target to \$225 from \$140, citing the multi-vector pivot beyond handsets into automotive, IoT, AR/VR, and the emerging hyperscaler data-center silicon engagement. Sets a forward marker into the June 24 Investor Day where management is expected to quantify the data-center opportunity.

AMD — Rackspace MOU. Rackspace and AMD announced a memorandum of understanding to develop an enterprise AI cloud tailored for regulated industries and sovereign workloads. Rackspace shares gained 12.5% on the announcement; AMD continues to add hyperscaler and enterprise deployment vectors on top of the OpenAI and Meta commitments already disclosed.

PORTFOLIO PERFORMANCE

DIVIDEND STRATEGY

✓ BEAT ONE

+0.20%

vs. DVY -0.11% | SPY +0.83%

GROWTH PORTFOLIO

X TRAIL

+1.18%

vs. IUSG +1.23%

YEAR-TO-DATE

Dividend +12.06% vs DVY +7.89% / SPY +8.17%

Growth +10.16% vs IUSG +10.57%